

JAMIL RAFIQUE SHAIKH

Senior SRE & Platform Engineer | Talos Linux Specialist | Available for Contract & Consulting

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CONSULTING FOCUS

Available for remote contract and consulting engagements in SRE, platform engineering, and Kubernetes infrastructure. Primary specialisation: **Talos Linux cluster buildouts and migrations** (from Juju, RKE2, Rancher, kubeadm), **multi-cluster GitOps** with ArgoCD and FluxCD, and **AI-assisted reliability engineering**. 11+ years in production — telecom, FinTech, cloud-native SaaS.

CORE SKILLS

- Kubernetes & Platform:** Talos Linux, Cilium (eBPF + BGP), Hubble, Kyverno, KEDA, Longhorn, MetalLB, CloudNativePG, Helm, OpenShift, Rancher, kubeadm, HPA, RBAC, rolling upgrades.
- GitOps & CI/CD:** ArgoCD (App-of-Apps), FluxCD, Kustomize, GitHub Actions, Azure DevOps, Jenkins, GitLab CI, environment promotion, automated rollback patterns.
- Observability:** VictoriaMetrics, Grafana, Loki, Prometheus, Alloy, Datadog, Sumo Logic, SLI/SLO definition, alerting, dashboards, MTTR/MTTD reduction.
- IaC & Automation:** Terraform, Ansible, Crossplane, Bash, Python.
- Cloud:** AWS (EKS), GCP (GKE), Azure (AKS), Proxmox, OpenStack, VMware Tanzu.
- Security & Secrets:** Kyverno policy enforcement, HC Vault, Harbor, Trivy Operator, CVE remediation, SAST/SCA/DAST.
- SRE:** Incident response, RCA, postmortems, runbooks, error budgets, on-call, ITSM/ITIL.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Consultant — Senior SRE | Improving India (formerly InfraCloud Technologies) (Sep 2024 – Present)

Clients: Medtronic, Acquia, Beamer | Keywords: VMware Tanzu, GKE, EKS, Kubernetes, ArgoCD, FluxCD, GitHub Actions, Prometheus, Grafana, SLI/SLO, ITSM

- Medtronic** — Lead SRE productionising an industrial IoT manufacturing pipeline for rollout to 65 global sites. Containerised a 4-component stack (HiveMQ MQTT, Ignition SCADA, PostgreSQL/CNPG, Kafka Connect) on VMware Tanzu, delivered to a regulated environment with a full Evidence Pack.
- Acquia** — SRE for enterprise digital experience platform on AWS. Established SLO-driven alerting, hardened Kubernetes deployment pipelines, built runbooks that cut incident response time. Turned CVE remediation into a tracked GitOps-native operation with audit trails across GKE/EKS.
- Beamer** — Migrated 15 applications from GCP App Engine to GKE: containerised workloads, Helm packaging, GitHub Actions CI/CD, cost visibility. Improved MTTR/MTTD through focused dashboards and actionable alerts.

Senior DevOps Engineer | Opcito Technologies (Oct 2022 – Sep 2024)

Client: EMTECH (CBDC/FinTech) | Keywords: Azure, AKS, Terraform, Azure DevOps, Datadog, SAST/DAST

- Deployed and maintained 14 AKS clusters for a central banking / CBDC platform with zero-tolerance for deployment failures.
- Built extensive Azure DevOps CI/CD with environment promotion gates, automated validation, and rollback triggers.
- Reduced security incidents by 40% (SAST/SCA/DAST); cut cloud spend by 20% through right-sizing and autoscaling; improved deployment consistency by 30%.

Senior Engineer R&D DevOps | Alepo Technologies (Aug 2021 – Oct 2022)

Keywords: OpenShift, OpenStack, Jenkins, Helm, 5G VNF, Samsung Korea

- Led OpenShift deployment on OpenStack for Samsung Korea 5G Virtual Network Function workloads. Built Jenkins pipelines, Helm charts with integrated tracing/alerting, and jMeter load validation at carrier scale.

Professional Services DevOps Engineer | Allot Communications (Nov 2019 – Jul 2021)

Keywords: Kubernetes HA, OpenStack, Ansible, Telecom — ePLDT, Airtel, Lycamobile, MTN Uganda

- Deployed on-prem Kubernetes HA clusters on OpenStack for telecom operators across Philippines, India, and Uganda. On-site delivery; Ansible automation replaced manual undocumented steps with repeatable auditable playbooks.

Linux Server Administrator | Change Networks · Super Petroleum (Jan 2015 – Apr 2019)

Linux/Windows servers, pfSense, LDAP, AWS migrations — the systems and networking foundation that underpins everything above.

SELECTED PROJECTS

openclaw — AI SRE Agent (*Production, running on homelab cluster*)

Kubernetes-native AI Site Reliability Engineer: cron-based agent that monitors cluster health, detects CrashLoopBackOff and pod failures, correlates incidents, auto-remediates within policy, posts structured alerts to Mattermost, and generates postmortems. Powered by Claude Haiku to keep inference costs near zero. Phase 3 adds runbook intelligence and capacity forecasting.

Stack: Python, Kubernetes CronJob, Anthropic Claude, Mattermost, ArgoCD

Talos Proxmox GitOps — Production Homelab Platform — <https://github.com/jamilshaikh07/talos-proxmox-gitops>

Three-layer IaC: Terraform VM provisioning → Ansible/Talos bootstrap → ArgoCD App-of-Apps managing 27 live applications alongside FluxCD. Cilium with BGP, MetalLB, Traefik, Cloudflare Tunnel, VictoriaMetrics, Velero DR, Trivy Operator. Hosts real products: spinup.in PaaS, openclaw AI SRE, BPL production app, Mattermost.

Stack: Talos Linux, Kubernetes, Terraform, Ansible, ArgoCD, FluxCD, Cilium, VictoriaMetrics

spinup.in — Self-Hosted PaaS — <https://spinup.in>

Push-to-deploy platform on bare-metal Talos Kubernetes. Go control plane, GitHub App webhooks, Kaniko rootless builds, per-tenant CNPG Postgres, Traefik IngressRoute, external-dns, Cloudflare Tunnel. Multi-tenant, serving real traffic.

Stack: Go, Kubernetes, Talos Linux, Kaniko, CloudNativePG, Traefik, Cloudflare

autofix-dojo — CVE Remediation Automation — <https://github.com/jamilshaikh07/autofix-dojo>

GitOps-native tool: watches DefectDojo, maps CVEs to running workloads, bumps image versions, opens PRs via GitHub/GitLab APIs, tracks SLO compliance on remediation timelines. Prometheus metrics, web dashboard.

Stack: Go, Kubernetes, DefectDojo, GitOps, Operator SDK

CERTIFICATIONS

- CKAD — Certified Kubernetes Application Developer (CNCF)
- AZ-400 — Azure DevOps Engineer Expert (Microsoft)
- AZ-104 — Azure Administrator Associate (Microsoft)
- HashiCorp Terraform Associate

EDUCATION

- B.Sc. Information Technology — Pillai's College, Mumbai (2014–2018)
- Diploma in Computer Engineering — DY Patil Polytechnic, Mumbai (2007–2013)